

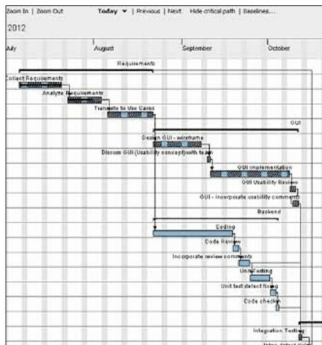


Figure 7: Critical path in the sample GUI project

format. The tool has provision to enter tasks, resources, a holiday calendar and dependencies, manually, to create a new project plan. As part of the process features, GanttProject generates the Gantt chart and PERT charts based on the provided input. It allows the exporting of project data into MS Project format, images, HTML reports, CSV files and PDF reports.

GanttProject allows you to view the *critical path* in the project. In Figure 7, you can see that during the design and implementation phase, the GUI stream is on the critical path, and not the back-end.

There is also a feature to save baseline versions of the project. This is useful during the initial stages of draft versions, and also when you freeze the schedule before starting execution. The tool allows you to create multiple baselines.

Other free PM tools

Two other products worth mentioning in the category of PM tools are *OpenProj* and *Open Workbench*. The former is also an open source tool developed in Java, available from *sourceforge*.

net. It has much higher capabilities, such as filtering based on task status, sorting and grouping. It also has multiple views such as the 'work breakdown structure', resource breakdown structure, network view, etc. The user can also select the split view, which enables you to take a look at the work breakdown structure on the top pane, for instance, and task usage in the bottom pane. The UI and features are closer to MS Project.

Open Workbench is a freeware alternative to MS Project. The latest version, 2.0.0, has a 'ribbon' bar similar to recent MS Office versions. The features are comparable, and advanced features such as resource levelling, variance analysis and auto scheduling are available. *Open Workbench* is suitable for seasoned project and program managers, who need to manage complex or multiple interrelated projects. The version available at *sourceforge.net* is old (1.1.4). To get the latest version, visit the link mentioned in *References*. CA Clarity PPM is the commercial enterprise version of the same PM tool.

GanttProject is an ideal choice for novices as well as experienced project managers. It is simple to use and has all the basic capabilities to schedule, create a baseline, and assess the critical path of a project. The map can also be exported as a PDF or an SVG file. 

References

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- [2] GanttProject Tutorial video: <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5rHC5a5ad34>
- [3] Open Workbench latest version 2.0.0 and 2.0.1 download location: <http://www.itdesign.de/en/ppm/open-workbench/overview.html>
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